

—THE REPAIR WORK—



For the

BETRAYED

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— RUPTURE · REPAIR · RECONNECT —

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Worksheet Appendix

These worksheets are designed to be completed alongside the book, ideally in collaboration with a licensed mental health professional. All worksheets include environment considerations — guidance about when, where, and how to complete each exercise safely.

How to Use These Worksheets

Every worksheet in this appendix includes an Environment Considerations box at the top. Please read this section before beginning any exercise. These considerations are not optional — they are part of the clinical design of the worksheet.

Betrayal trauma is a physiological event. Your nervous system does not distinguish between a worksheet prompt and an actual threat. The wrong environment, wrong timing, or wrong emotional state can cause a worksheet exercise to become retraumatizing rather than healing. The environment considerations exist to prevent that.

What “Window of Tolerance” Means

Your window of tolerance is the zone of arousal in which your nervous system can process difficult material without going into survival mode. Inside this window, you feel present, grounded, and capable of thinking clearly. Outside it — either above (flooded, panicked, overwhelmed) or below (shut down, numb, dissociated) — processing shuts down.

Before beginning any worksheet, check your current arousal level on a 0–10 scale:

- 0–3** You are very calm. Some worksheets that require light reflection are fine.
- 4–5** You are in a good zone for most worksheet work. Proceed with full awareness.
- 6–7** Proceed cautiously, or only with a therapist present. Skip heavy-content worksheets.
- 8–10** STOP. Do not begin any worksheet. Use grounding tools first. Contact your therapist.

Standard Grounding Toolkit

If you become overwhelmed during any worksheet, use these before continuing or reaching out for support:

- **5-4-3-2-1:** Name 5 things you can see, 4 you can touch, 3 you can hear, 2 you can smell, 1 you can taste.
- **Vagus nerve breath:** In for 4 counts, hold 4, out for 8. Repeat 3–5 times.

- **Physical anchor:** Press feet into floor, hands on knees, feel the weight of your own body.
- *Verbal anchor: “I am being triggered. I am not in danger. I am in the present. This will pass.”*

Your Support Contacts

My therapist / counselor

My crisis contact (person I trust)

Crisis line I can call

National Crisis Line: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline — call or text 988

My Trigger Map

Purpose: *Identify and name your personal triggers before they ambush you, so your nervous system has a map instead of a minefield.*

TIME NEEDED	30–45 minutes
ENVIRONMENT	Private, quiet space. No music that could activate memories. Tissues available. Complete alone — do not share with your partner while completing.
✓ BEFORE YOU BEGIN	Check your distress level (0–10). Only proceed if 5 or below. Have your grounding toolkit within reach. Read “How to Use These Worksheets” if you haven’t.
COMPLETE THIS WHEN	A calm period — not the same day as a triggering event. Ideally 48+ hours after your last major trigger response.
✗ DO NOT COMPLETE WHEN	During or immediately after a conflict. When you are already in a flooded state. When your partner is in the room or nearby and you cannot have privacy.
▮ IF YOU BECOME OVERWHELMED	Put down the pen. Use the 5-4-3-2-1 grounding method. Take the vagus nerve breath. If distress reaches 8+, stop completely and contact your therapist. You can return to this worksheet on a calmer day.

Part 1: Known Triggers

A trigger is anything — a sensory input, a word, a date, a situation — that causes your nervous system to relive the trauma. List yours. Include sensory details (sounds, smells, places, times of day) as specifically as you can.

Sensory triggers (songs, smells, sounds, specific locations)

Situational triggers (specific scenarios, times, contexts)

Relational triggers (things your partner does, says, or fails to do)

Date/time-based triggers (anniversaries, times of day, seasons)

Part 2: What Happens in My Body

When a trigger hits, your body responds before your mind does. Map your personal physical response:

My first body sensation is usually

What happens to my breathing

What happens to my heart rate

Where I feel tension in my body

Signs that I am approaching my limit (before I flood)

Part 3: My Automatic Responses

What do you tend to do when triggered? Be honest — there are no wrong answers here.

I tend to (circle all that apply): Withdraw and go quiet · Cry · Get angry · Leave the room · Shut down · Seek reassurance · Ask questions · Go over it again mentally · Reach for my phone · Other

Other automatic responses I notice

What I most need when triggered (even if I can't always ask for it)

Part 4: My Regulation Toolkit

Which regulation strategies from Chapter 2 work best for you? Personalize them here.

My most effective grounding technique

The breathing approach that helps me most

Movement that helps me discharge adrenaline

My verbal anchor (what I say to myself)

The environment I need to regulate (outside, my room, car, etc.)

Part 5: What I Need From My Partner

Complete this section when you are calm. Share it with your partner during a non-triggered moment — in session with your therapist if possible.

When I am triggered, what helps most is

When I am triggered, what makes it worse is

The one thing I most need you to say is

The one thing I most need you NOT to say is

How I will let you know I'm triggered, even if I can't speak

Date completed: _____ Distress level at start (0–10): _____ At end: _____

Window of Tolerance Daily Check-In

Purpose: A brief daily self-monitoring tool to help you track your nervous system state and make informed decisions about what you can handle today.

TIME NEEDED	5–10 minutes (designed for daily use)
ENVIRONMENT	Can be completed anywhere you have 5 minutes of privacy. Morning is ideal — before the day's interactions shape your state.
✓ BEFORE YOU BEGIN	No special preparation needed. This is a low-intensity worksheet designed for daily use. If you are already in crisis, contact your therapist instead.
COMPLETE THIS WHEN	Daily, or before any significant conversation or therapeutic activity. Especially useful before couples therapy sessions or difficult discussions.
✗ DO NOT COMPLETE WHEN	This worksheet has no contraindications. It is always appropriate.
▮ IF YOU BECOME OVERWHELMED	If completing this check-in reveals you are already at 8+, stop and use your grounding toolkit. Text your therapist if needed. Do not attempt other worksheets today.

Complete this check-in once per day. Photocopy or reproduce the daily log below.

Date: _____

Step 1: Body Scan

Close your eyes for 30 seconds. Notice what is happening in your body right now. Then respond:

Physical sensations I notice right now

Where I feel tension or tightness

My breathing is (circle one): Shallow / Normal / Deep / Tight / I'm not sure

Step 2: Distress Level

My current distress level: No distress [1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10] Maximum distress

My window of tolerance today (circle one): OPEN (4–6: can process, feel, engage) NARROW (6–7: proceed cautiously) CLOSED (8+: stop, ground, reach out)

Step 3: Today's Capacity

What I feel capable of handling in my relationship today

What I need to protect myself from today (situations, conversations, content)

One thing I can do today to support my own healing

Step 4: End-of-Day Reflection

Complete this section before bed.

My distress level at end of day: No distress [1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10] Maximum distress

What triggered me today (if anything)

How I regulated (what I did, what helped)

One thing I'm proud of myself for today

— — — *Reproduce this page for daily use* — — —

My Boundaries and Safety Plan

Purpose: *Articulate the non-negotiable conditions you need to begin healing — and establish a clear plan for what you will do if those conditions are violated.*

TIME NEEDED	40–60 minutes
ENVIRONMENT	Private, uninterrupted. Bring this worksheet to your individual or couples therapy session if possible — having a therapist present when you articulate these boundaries can strengthen your ability to hold them.
✓ BEFORE YOU BEGIN	Distress level 5 or below. You need to be calm enough to think clearly, not reactive enough that fear is doing the writing.
COMPLETE THIS WHEN	After you have read at least through Chapter 4 of the book. After a period of relative calm (not right after a conflict). Best completed before a scheduled conversation with your partner about what they can do to support your healing.
✗ DO NOT COMPLETE WHEN	During or immediately after a conflict. When you are flooded or emotionally escalated. When you feel pressured to produce this by your partner (this is yours — complete it for yourself, on your timeline).
► IF YOU BECOME OVERWHELMED	Stop and ground. This worksheet asks you to name painful truths about what you need, and that can be activating. Take a break. Come back. Do not rush this document — it matters too much.

Part 1: My Non-Negotiable Safety Conditions

These are the conditions that must exist for you to consider working on the relationship. They are not demands or punishments — they are the minimum conditions under which your nervous system can begin to feel safe. Be specific.

Around transparency (phone, location, communication)

Around honesty (what I need them to tell me, how quickly, about what)

Around patience and pacing (what I need them NOT to do regarding my timeline)

Around their individual work (therapy, accountability, understanding why they did this)

Around intimacy (what I need before I'm willing to rebuild physical closeness)

Other conditions not listed above

Part 2: What Holding These Boundaries Looks Like

Knowing your boundaries is one thing. Holding them when challenged is another. Be concrete about what holding them actually means.

If a boundary is crossed, my first response will be

The boundary I am most afraid to hold is

The story I tell myself when I consider lowering a boundary ("I'm being too demanding," etc.)

What I want to tell that story

Part 3: My Response Protocol

If a condition is violated — if a boundary is crossed — what will you do? Having this written down in advance means you don't have to decide in the moment.

If ___ happens, I will

- ☐ Tell my partner directly and clearly what happened and what I need now
- ☐ Contact my therapist to process this before responding further
- ☐ Take space to regulate before having a conversation
- ☐ Revisit whether I can continue in this process
- ☐ Other:

Part 4: My Support Network

You should not be doing this work alone. Name the people and resources that are part of your healing ecosystem.

My therapist / counselor

A trusted friend I can be honest with

A family member who supports me (if applicable)

A support group or community (if applicable)

Crisis line / resource

Part 5: My Commitment to Myself

Write a brief commitment — in your own words — to the person you are through this process.

I commit to

Date completed: _____ Reviewed with therapist: _____ (date)

Healing Stage Inventory

Purpose: Track where you are in the healing process over time — not to measure progress against a standard, but to understand your own experience and honor how far you have come.

TIME NEEDED	20–30 minutes
ENVIRONMENT	Private, calm. This is a reflective inventory, not a heavy processing worksheet. A cup of tea and a quiet space are enough.
✓ BEFORE YOU BEGIN	Any distress level up to 6 is appropriate for this worksheet. It is designed to be emotionally manageable.
COMPLETE THIS WHEN	Once a month, on a day you have chosen in advance (not a crisis day). Review your previous entries before completing the current one.
✗ DO NOT COMPLETE WHEN	In the middle of an acute crisis or right after a triggering event. Wait until you have returned to baseline.
▮ IF YOU BECOME OVERWHELMED	This worksheet should not trigger acute distress. If it does, that is important information — something in the question is touching a live wound. Note it, use your grounding tools, and bring it to therapy.

Complete this inventory once per month. Date each entry so you can track changes over time.

Date: _____ Month _____ of my healing process

Part 1: Where I Am Right Now

From Chapter 5, the five stages are: The Shattering / The Flood / The Wrestling / The Grieving / The Rebuilding. Stages overlap and repeat — you may be in more than one at once.

The stage(s) that best describe where I am this month

What this stage feels like from the inside right now

Part 2: What Is Shifting

Trigger frequency (this month vs. last): Much more frequent [1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10] Much less frequent

Trigger intensity (when they hit): More intense [1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10] Less intense

Recovery time after a trigger: Takes longer [1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10] Recovering faster

Safety in my own body: Still unsafe [1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10] Feeling safer

Something that is genuinely easier than it was last month

Something that is still hard in the same way

Something that surprised me about my healing this month

Part 3: Healing Milestones

Check any milestones you have reached since last month (or for the first time):

- ☐ Went a full day without thinking about the affair
- ☐ Had a trigger and recovered within an hour
- ☐ Laughed — really laughed — without feeling guilty
- ☐ Made a decision from clarity rather than fear
- ☐ Said something I needed to say and actually got heard
- ☐ Had a moment of genuine connection with my partner
- ☐ Chose myself — my needs, my wellbeing — without apology
- ☐ Slept through the night
- ☐ Other:

Part 4: What I Need This Month

From my therapist

From my partner

From myself

One thing I want to focus on for my own healing in the coming month

Date completed: _____ Next inventory scheduled:

Stay or Leave Clarity Worksheet

Purpose: A structured framework for approaching the most important decision you may face — not to rush you toward an answer, but to help you access your own knowing.

TIME NEEDED	45–90 minutes. Do not rush this.
ENVIRONMENT	CRITICAL: Private, safe, calm. This worksheet is only appropriate in a regulated state. Ideally complete with your therapist present, or bring it to your next session immediately after. Do not complete this worksheet and then immediately confront your partner.
✓ BEFORE YOU BEGIN	Distress level 4 or below. This is a high-stakes reflective exercise. It requires your full rational capacity — which means you must not be flooded. If in doubt, wait.
COMPLETE THIS WHEN	Only after you have read Chapter 6 in full. Only after you have been in some form of therapeutic support for at least several weeks. Only when you are not in an acute crisis. Only when you have not just had a significant conflict.
✗ DO NOT COMPLETE WHEN	During or immediately after a triggering event. When you are extremely distressed (7+). When you feel pressured by your partner to produce an answer. When you are exhausted or have not slept.
■ IF YOU BECOME OVERWHELMED	STOP IMMEDIATELY. Put the worksheet down. Use grounding tools. Contact your therapist before returning. This worksheet touches the center of the wound — it requires your steadiest self. If it is destabilizing you, that is information: you may not be ready to answer this question yet, and that is okay.

This worksheet is for you alone. It does not produce a binding decision. It is a thinking tool — a way of organizing what you already know, under your own terms, at your own pace.

Part 1: Body Check First

Before your mind answers anything, check your body. Your body has information your reasoning mind may be avoiding.

When I imagine staying in this relationship, my body feels

When I imagine leaving, my body feels

Which response feels like fear, and which feels like truth?

Part 2: The Five Questions From Chapter 6

Answer each question based on observable evidence — what your partner has actually done — not on what you hope or fear.

1. Is my partner truly accountable? (Not just sorry — actually accountable.)

2. Am I safe with my partner? (Emotionally safe — able to be vulnerable without fearing re-injury.)

3. Is my partner genuinely patient? (Not just saying they are — actually demonstrating it.)

4. Is my partner transparent? (Have nothing to hide — and proving it consistently.)

5. Am I staying out of love — or out of fear?

Part 3: What I Know

Complete these sentences with the first honest thing that comes.

The truth I keep avoiding about staying is

The truth I keep avoiding about leaving is

What I most need right now — regardless of what I decide — is

If I had no fear about the consequences, my gut answer would be

Part 4: The In-Between

If you don't have a clear answer yet, that is allowed. You are allowed to stay in the question. Name where you are:

What I need to see or experience before I can answer

The timeline I am giving myself to continue observing

Date completed: _____ Shared with therapist: _____ (date)

DO NOT share with partner until discussed with therapist